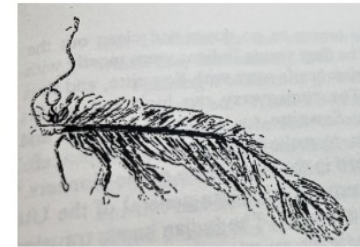




HENRY LUNT

“Chief Walker had the Peace Pipe charged and we smoked all around.
There were ‘some twenty braves.’”



CHAPTER X
THE WALKER WAR
1853

When the Mormons were colonizing the Utah Territory, they went out of their way to keep on friendly terms with the Indians. The Mormon people kept a friendly attitude towards the redmen and continued to give them gifts and encouraged them to learn the Mormon culture. Thus, the Indians eventually began to know the difference between Mormons and other white men. This, as a rule, produced an immunity from attack by the Indians. Nevertheless, the settlers were constantly on the lookout and careful not to antagonize or cause any problems with the local tribes.¹

When the pioneers came into the valley of the Great Salt Lake in 1847, a large number of Indians were encamped in Spanish Fork Canyon. As soon as the news reached them of the arrival of the pioneers, the Indians held a council to determine what course they should pursue in relationship to the whites. Soweitte, an older chief of one of the tribes, was known to be friendly with the whites. He advised the council to let the Mormon pioneers alone and pursue a policy of peace toward them saying that they, perhaps like the Ute nation, had been driven to the Rocky Mountains for security. Actually the Indians of Utah were wandering tribes of the Shoshones. Soweitte had obtained this view of the pioneers from his scouts who had already had contact with the travelers. Chief Walker, who was the

Henry Lunt Biography

younger warrior, urged his braves to go down and clean out the whites from their valleys. The fiery young Indians were mostly with Walker, while the older and wiser heads were with Soweitte, and thus the council was divided. The controversy ran high and, in his indignation and royal wrath, Soweitte took his riding whip and flogged the war chief, Walker, to make him behave. The peaceful attitude of the older Indians helped in the acceptance of the pioneers.²

Chief Walker was a very resourceful Indian general of the Ute Tribe who used uncanny military strategy. The Indian bands traveled extensively up and down the territory stopping near different communities to obtain food from the settlers. Brigham Young's advice was to be friendly with the Indians. He said, "It is better to feed them than to fight them." When Wilford Woodruff came in contact with Chief Walker he thought him to be "a rather ugly looking specimen for an Indian Chief." The true Paiute Indians are close relatives of the Utes.³ It was believed that the heads of the tribes under Walker were all related and that the chief of the Pihedes, better known as Paiutes, who had headquarters on Coal Creek was a brother to Chief Walker. The domain of the Paiute Indians included that country between Millard County south to the Virgin River.

The settlers at Cedar Fort had their problems with the Indians but were usually able to work them out satisfactorily. Henry wrote:

Sunday, February 6, 1853: Walker, the Indian Chief, and a small band of Indians came and camped by the side of the small mountain east of the fort yesterday. They had a large band of horses with them. Walker made inquiries for me, but I did not see him until today. I went about one o'clock and took along Nephi Johnson to interpret for me. Father Whittaker and several brethren accompanied me. Just as I was going, Brother Gould's man who was attending the coal pits at the Iron Works came running to me and said that one of the pits had bursted out and set fire to the cord wood. I immediately called out in the fort that the wood pile at the Iron Works was on fire and

that I wished for the brethren to run with buckets, which they immediately did.

Thinking it wisdom to go and see Chief Walker the while, I did so. When I first entered his tent, which was very extensive and an excellent one, he shook hands with me and invited me to sit down by his side on a blanket, which I did. He seemed very quiet and did not manifest a very friendly spirit for some time. When I lived at Parowan, I had a rifle which Walker wanted to get off me for a horse but, not being lawful for to trade guns with the Indians at that time, of course I did not trade. He told me that he did not like me so well on that account and, if I would give him a shirt, he would be friends with me. I told him, through Nephi, that I should not buy his friendship by giving him a shirt for I was his friend all the time and, consequently, had no occasion to give him anything on that account. I told him, inasmuch as he and his people would do right, the Mormons were his friends. I also told him that some of the Utahs had shot some Pihedes and that the Mormons did not like the Utahs for that, for it was very wicked of them to kill one another and the Lord was very angry with them for killing. He, afterwards, manifested a most excellent spirit and said he was mad at the Utah men for killing the Pihedes and when he heard of it he cried. He said he was friendly with the Pihedes and also said that there was a great number of Pihedes east of this place over the mountains who had never seen any white men yet. He said they must not steal any of the Mormon's cattle, for the Mormons were a good people. He also said that it was not my fault that I did not trade him my rifle. He said he was 'tooich ticaboo,' which means 'very friendly' with me. I then invited him and Amon, his brother, to dine with me on Monday and he said he would. He also said they were very hungry

and had no meat and would be very glad if I would have my people give them some flour and potatoes. I said that I would. He had the large [peace] pipe charged and we smoked all around, some twenty braves, the pipe of peace. I then left and attended the afternoon's meeting, Sacrament Sunday.

I called for the report of the teachers which each one gave in and, as a general thing, the reports were very good. Brother and Sister Ashworth would not receive the teachers, as saints should do, and manifested a very bad spirit. They both were disfellowshipped from the Church until they made restitution to the teachers. According to the instructions I received from President J. C. L. Smith, I informed Brother Wood and Brother Benson, who had been fighting, that they must not receive the sacrament. Brother Wood insisted on speaking before the sacrament was administered, but I refused him the privilege as I did not consider it wisdom as President Smith had informed them he wished for both of them to meet before the Bishop on Monday night. Brother Wood manifested a very bad spirit and said that it was not right that he was not allowed to speak.

Monday, February 7, 1853: At noon Bishop Smith, with his carriage, drove myself and Walker, the Utah Chief, and Ammon over to my house. I also invited Brother Carruthers and Nephi Johnson who also came. The dinner party consisted of Walker, the great 'King of the Mountains,' Amon and his brother, Toniamp, and another Utah brave, a Pihede Indian, Father Whittaker and James Whittaker, Mary and Sarah, Ellen and myself, Brother Carruthers and Nephi Johnson. We had a good plain substantial dinner. Walker manifested a very good spirit. He ate, he said, until he was full up to the neck. After dinner we went up to the Iron Works and I showed my visitors the

Works and explained things to them as well as I could. Walker seemed very much pleased and interested with the Works

Henry wrote a letter to George A. Smith on February 11, 1853, telling of the conditions in Cedar City and describing the events with Chief Walker:

Dear Brother Smith:

Knowing your most anxious desire at all times for to hear of the welfare and prosperity of the saints in Iron County, I will endeavor to say a little.

It has always been peace and prosperity since we first rolled into camp on Center Creek with the 101 wagons and no saints to bid us welcome. But a few of the poorest kind of Indians who were scared at the sight of a white man, was the only token of any of the human family roaming in this sublime part of God's creation, but now, and in but a little over two years, what is the appearance--three large cities are being built and a number of forts and smaller settlements made and cattle ranches established stretching out for more than 50 miles, including some of the best fenced fields, I will venture to say, in the Territory. Manufactories of different kinds are erected and being erected, among which is the blast furnace sending forth its clouds of smoke above the mountain tops. And, verily I may say, this part of the Lord's vineyard bids fair to become--and that, too, in a very short time--the great emporium for manufacture, commerce, and wealth, and also an endless quantity of the very choicest of land which will grow any kind of grain and vegetable, for we have proved it.

All is peace and prosperity--no sickness, no death as yet in the valley--at peace with the natives. Walker, the Indian Chief, is here and has been a week. I had

him and four more dining with me on Monday. Gave him about 150 pounds of flour and a few potatoes which well-pleased him. I talked considerable with him and he manifested the best spirit I ever saw him do. He says, by and by, he intends settling down by us and cultivating the earth. I talked to him about some of his men killing some 5 Pihedes a short time since, and he said he was mad at them for doing so. Walker was not with the band that killed the Pihedes, he was over with the Moquitch Indians at the time.

Henry Lunt⁴

The Indians were not very civilized in their manners and customs; yet they retained many honorable traditions of their fathers and were, as a rule, honest in their dealings with the whites. However, there were some renegade bands that did not follow these traditions. The settlers always felt that they should be wary and not be too trusting of the Indians and there were a few incidents that caused the residents to fear their actions. One such experience happened earlier in the winter when an Indian returning from Harmony on Wednesday, February 16, delivered a letter to Henry written by John D. Lee and Elisha Groves which contained information that two Mormons had been killed by Indians. The men had left their wagon and gone a good way off without their guns searching for iron when five Indians attacked them. Brother John Steele and Robert Gallespie, two settlers from Cedar Fort, had gone out looking for scrap iron and when Henry and President Smith went to the Indian's wickiup who had brought the letter, he described the two brethren killed as being these men. The letter stated that the five marauding Indians had gone to the Rio Virgin Indian camp and boasted of their deeds. The band of Indians by Cedar City were very upset about this action.

After some discussion, Henry and Smith concluded it would be wise for Brother Smith to return to Parowan and send a well-armed company in search of the brethren to see if the news was true. Seven men from Cedar and ten from Parowan left the next morning to search for the missing men. They were detained for a time because they did

not have enough horses. Brother Pugmire and Brother Bosnell refused very strongly to lend their horses to George Wood, Captain of the Minute Company. Two days later, Saturday, February 19, four of the men returned very early in the morning and advised Henry that all was well. They came in the house to warm themselves and told the correct story of what had happened. Two "gold diggers" had started out, apparently for California, and they were the men that had been killed. Henry wrote: "It seems that they were wicked, swearing men; hence, fulfills scripture, 'the wicked shall not live out half their days.' Our men met Brother Steel and company 45 miles from here all well, with three loads of iron."

After this incident Henry saw Chief Walker and conversed with him telling him to preach to the Indians to behave themselves and not come into the houses of the settlers unless they were invited. Walker dined with Henry and Ellen that evening, February 21, and was very friendly. He said he would talk to the Pihede Indians.

Another experience which reinforced the fact that the Indians could not always be trusted happened on the evening of May 30, 1853. Two Parviant Indians shot at the local Pihedes in their wickiups and drove off two oxen. Henry visited the Pihede camp and found that six Indians were trailing the Parvants. He tried to get some of the Minute Company to follow but could only get a few men. Matthew Carruthers and Henry tried to get Dan Ross to go but he refused. Henry wrote, "I bore with him some time and visited him twice, but all of no use. I asked him to let someone use his horse and he, again, refused." The group, which agreed to go, started at about nine a.m. on May 31, on horseback. Those included were Henry, Matthew Carruthers, James Whittaker, William Walker, John Stoddart, James Thorpe, Thomas Mecham, Derius Davis, and a Pihede Indian named Moquachec. They didn't take any provisions because they thought they would be able to find the marauders in a matter of hours. They soon "struck the track" of two oxen and the moccasin tracks of two Indians and followed them in a northwest direction past a large lake (Rush Lake) and over the mountains and into a beautiful valley west of the Beaver Valley where they camped. Their meal consisted of two small rabbits supplemented by a little

bread. The night was cold, especially since "some of the boys had neither coat nor vest." The next morning, after they had traveled about seven miles, they found the thief's campfire, which was still burning. It wasn't long before they caught up and charged after them with all the speed that the horses would go, but the two Indians left the cattle and jumped into the stream (Beaver River) and were able to get away. Henry's group found the thief's clothes, an excellent rifle, a powder horn and bullet pouch, a fur cap, and a butcher knife which they gave to the Pihede who seemed to be very pleased. They had no prisoners but they returned with the cattle. Ironically, the two oxen proved to belong to Dan Ross who had refused to help them. They had traveled almost fifty miles by this time and were getting quite hungry. Their old Indian, who they had christened "Moses," shot a hare with his bow and arrows and Henry wrote: "A sweeter morsel I have never eaten." The next day they shot four small rabbits and Moses cooked them. Henry wrote: "We were so starved that the Indian ate even the guts of the first rabbit and we polished up the whole of the remainder, with the exception of the guts, but they were pretty well basted with the contents of the same."

Several brethren from Cedar Fort came out to meet the group and everyone was thankful they returned home safely. On Friday, June 3, two Pavant Indians came to the Pihede wickiups and wanted to get the gun back from "Moses," who wouldn't give it up. At first, they thought the two might be the thieves, but the prisoners proved they were in Parowan at the time the cattle were stolen so they were released. On Tuesday, June 21, an old Indian shot Brother Walker's mare with an arrow, claiming that the horse had gotten into the Indians' field. Since the Indians had not fenced their field, Henry instructed them that they must guard their property. They brought a younger Indian to take the place of the older one and they gave him "a few stripes" as punishment.

Each settlement in the Utah Territory held a celebration on the 4th of July 1853, commemorating the anniversary of American independence. A large crowd gathered around the Tabernacle in Salt Lake City after an extensive parade which included the Mormon Battalion, the Nauvoo Brass Band, and the officers of the Nauvoo

Legion. The escort arrived at Governor Young's at 9:00 a.m. and everyone saluted him at the west door of his mansion as he appeared on the steps.⁵ The residents of Cedar City held their own celebration and Henry wrote the following about the occasion:

Myself and Council bought an ox and had it slaughtered and cut up and divided amongst all the saints, every few families dining together. At nine o'clock a.m. the brethren mustered together and drilled, and then prepared a military pole for to raise. Dined at one o'clock. At ½ past two p.m., six guns were fired for the brethren to assemble themselves together at the place where the pole was to be raised, and they hoisted a sixty-foot pole with a fine flag on the top with the following motto: 'Holiness to the Lord.' Also drawn on the flag was a steam engine, a blast furnace, a cannon, and other machinery. When the pole was erected a salute was fired and we all gave three cheers. We then retired to the Meeting House. I spoke a short time on the celebration of the 4th of July, instructing the congregation that General Washington was raised up of the Lord to do a work preparatory to God's Kingdom being set up, and that the constitution of the United States is holy, just, and good, and will abide forever, but the administrators thereof are corrupt and wicked and do not deal out justice according to the laws of the constitution. It was not that I particularly cared about the celebration of the 4th of July, but I believe there was policy in celebrating it at the present time.

After the meeting, they held a party where there was only room for about fifty couples to dance at a time. Another dance was held in the evening which lasted until midnight.

On July 5, Brother Webb brought 115 pounds of flour from Paragonah for the men working at the iron company and wanted to trade

it for tea and tobacco. Henry and Brother Carruthers gave him what he asked for. A few days before, John D. Lee and Charles Dalton and their wives had brought thirteen cheeses to Henry for the Iron Works. The charge was 25 cents per pound.⁶ As provisions were getting scarce, Matthew Carruthers and Father Whittaker went to Parowan on July 15, and returned with forty bushels of ground wheat.

That same day, Brother James James made another trial run with the air furnace and some forty pounds of iron ran out of the furnace, which appeared to be good clear metal. On July 16, Henry wrote:

Charles P. Smith was brought before the Bishop for bad behavior with some of the sisters. He acknowledged his faults and asked for forgiveness. I was busy writing all day settling accounts with the brethren in the Iron Works and weighing out flour for them.

Monday, July 18, 1853: Another trial was made in the furnace and it became exceedingly hot. The arch over the grate burned through, and a small quantity of the adobes which it was built with fell in; consequently, nothing was done. It was the opinion of Brother James that the stack needed to be higher and the arch be built of fire brick. He seemed confident that the furnace, then, would make iron from the raw ore, if they had stone coal to burn.

The hostility of the Indians toward the settlers was becoming more and more apparent. Governor Young had warned all the settlements to prepare for any emergency that might come up. Many grievances had arisen between the white men and red men which could eventuate in bloodshed. The Indians made a practice of selling or trading their children and had attempted to sell their children to the Mormons, but they refused to take them. Brigham Young was trying to cut off all the trading of Indian children to the Mexicans to be used as slaves, and Walker became enraged when the Mormons intervened.⁷ These Indians had a revengeful disposition and believed in the doctrine of

retaliation. They never forgot an injury or an injustice. In other words, they subscribed to the worn out code of an "eye for an eye and a life for a life." With them the punishment of crime was a personal, rather than a public, matter. There was an avoidable altercation near Springville, July 17, 1853, over the exchange ratio of fish and flour resulting in the death of one Indian and a Mormon Guardsman, Alexander Keele.⁸

The die was cast. Quickly the hostiles fled to the mountains and into Sanpete County where, by surprise attacks, they hoped to spread death and destruction before the alarm became known. There were simultaneous attacks on the settlements of Pleasant Creek, Manti, Nephi and Springville on the 19th of July but the Indians were able to steal only a few cattle and horses. The settlers realized the wisdom of building forts and the quick availability of the local militia. While messengers were passing the danger signal between settlements, units of the Nauvoo Legion were forming. All the country south of Salt Lake City was gathered into one military district, to be accomplished by July 25, under the field command of Colonel George A. Smith. That day, July 25, Brigham Young issued a proclamation warning the saints. He also sent the following message to Chief Walker:

Captain Walker: I send you some tobacco for you to smoke in the mountains when you get lonesome. You are a fool for fighting your best friends, for we are the best friends, and the only friends that you have in the world. Everybody else would kill you if they could get a chance. If you get hungry, send some friendly Indian down to the settlements and we will give you some beef cattle and flour. If you are afraid of the tobacco which I send you, you can let some of your prisoners try it first and then you will know that it is good. When you get good-natured again, I would like to see you. Don't you think you should be ashamed? You know that I have always been your best friend.

Brigham Young⁹

On July 23rd, a contingent of the militia, sent from Manti on a scouting expedition, had a "brush" with a band of warriors at Pleasant Creek killing six or seven Indians.¹⁰ There were several other skirmishes during the summer. Captain Gunnison, who had explored the Great Salt Lake in 1849, returned in 1853 with a detachment of men to do some more exploring and surveying. They came into Utah by way of the Green River and were determined to explore the Sevier Lake before going to Salt Lake City for the winter. Ducks were plentiful and, on October 25, Gunnison's men began shooting at some. A band of Indians heard the firearms and, after Gunnison's party had retired, they surrounded their camp and, the following morning, massacred the entire party.¹¹

In spite of the threat of Indians which seemed to be taking place mostly in the northern part of the state, Cedar City continued on with a celebration on the 25th of July since the 24th fell on Sunday. George K. Bowering stated the following in his journal:

Battalion assembled at the Fort with a brass band. Then, all went over to Coal Creek, called the Little Muddy, unto a piece of ground appointed for a city and raised a liberty pole and ran upon it the Stars and Stripes. The dancing until daybreak went off first rate, and all appeared satisfied.

July 26, 1853: The boys got up a dance in the afternoon, when in the midst of dancing, in all the glory thereof, we were called out of the ballroom in the Bowery to listen to instructions or orders from headquarters, that is to say, from President Brigham Young, Governor of Utah Territory. The orders were to enforce Martial Law, in consequence of Indian difficulties.¹²

Governor Young issued the following orders on July 25:

I...Colonel G. A. Smith is hereby assigned to the command of all the Military Districts of the Territory south of Great Salt Lake

County, and is strictly enjoined and commanded to enforce the orders.

II...It is distinctly understood that all the people shall assemble into large and permanent forts and no man is at liberty to refuse to obey this order without being dealt with as our enemy.

III...All surplus stock that is not particularly needed for teams and milk must be driven to this city and placed in the charge of the Presiding Bishop of this city until further orders.

IV...Colonel Smith is fully authorized and required to carry out the instructions which have, heretofore, been occasionally given by the Governor and other authorities of the Territory in regard to defense, and all the people are now required to obey these instructions as Colonel Smith shall direct.

V...Colonel George A. Smith's instructions and orders will be those of the Executive of the Territory, and we will be sustained by him in enforcing the orders which, in his judgment, he thinks proper.¹³

By placing George A. Smith in command over the entire war zone, Governor Young neatly preempted all other militia commanders, and he could not have chosen a better man for the job. Smith was given the rank of Colonel to carry these orders out. He had taken little part in militia activities prior to this time. However, he was a powerful figure in every respect. He was a giant of a man in body, and a forceful and resolute man in style and personality. He was also an apostle who was extremely loyal to Brigham Young.

Brigham Young did not stop there. He instructed Smith to travel to every settlement south of Salt Lake City to make absolutely sure that every settler was informed. Then, apparently still not satisfied, he dispatched to Smith, who had already departed south, the following additional letter, which reads in part:

We now, as the First Presidency of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints, as Governor, Superintendent of Indian Affairs of Utah Territory and Commander in Chief of the Militia and Lieutenant General of the Nauvoo Legion, appeal to you, the Commandants of all the Military Districts south, to all

the officers and authorities of the Church of the Legion and of the Territory, and to all the people, and say unto you all, do not in the least degree relax your efforts to save your grain, your stock, and all your property, and fort up strong and permanent that your families and yourselves may be living and that you not be massacred by the Indians, and do not feel afraid that we want your property because we have ordered surplus stock to be driven to this place in order to keep you from feeding Indians with it, for we do not want it, but expect that you will draw it out when you can take care of it, although you had better put it into the Church Tithing Herd . . . And, we say further that, inasmuch as you do not second our efforts, carry into effect our orders and instructions, and listen to our counsel, we shall consider you as aliens and not brethren, as enemies and not friends, that we shall not hold you by our faith nor assist you by our influence nor our works. Enough has been said, works and not words are now required. Let your works speak and show for itself. Respectfully your brethren in the covenant of truth--Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, and Willard Richards. Brigham Young, Governor, Superintendent of Indian Affairs.¹⁴

The citizens of Cedar City opposed the order and their anger and defiance against sending livestock to Salt Lake was widespread, harsh, and sustained. When George A. Smith visited Cedar Fort, he found that the people were still openly defiant. Determined to achieve compliance, he gathered all the officers and leaders together and reread the general orders and asked if they would exonerate him from all further responsibilities relative to their surplus stock. Those in attendance unanimously answered, no. Smith wrote the following in his log concerning this visit:

One of the officers very gravely began to thank

God that they would have an apostle with them to help bear their burdens [referring to Franklin D. Richards, who was intending to stay in Cedar City]. When, on seeing their spirit manifested and the desire to throw all responsibility off from themselves onto someone else and not to obey the orders, I said immediately they could not have him and ordered him to be ready to march with me in one hour, telling them I would not risk the life of any good men with them or with any people who would not obey those orders of the Governor. I then spoke of men obtaining and holding influence by their works, etc. When I sat down, Major Carruthers presented his resignation which I accepted, and, after giving them some strong advice requiring them to obey the Governor's orders and to see them carried out, I dissolved the Council and later started for Parowan, taking Chaplain Richards along with me.

It appears that the "grave thanking of God" for Apostle Richards was intended as a direct insult to Apostle Smith, and perhaps even to the Prophet Brigham Young, to which insult Smith immediately responded with some strong advice. Smith's August 15 journal entry indicates that the people of Cedar City finally acquiesced, but only after the arrest of several citizens.

George A. Smith apparently came to Cedar City on August 5, with an exploration company under Lt. Colonel William H. Kimball. The following entry was written in the journal kept by this command:

Inspected the troops of this part [Cedar Fort] and found 110 men, 41 rifles, 13 muskets, 28 shotguns, 4 revolvers, 5 pistol holsters, 14 rockets, 2 carbines, 5 swords, 2 sabers, and 4, 433 rounds of ammunition. The people here are very backward in military affairs. Lt. Colonel James A. Little is very strict and puts the delinquents on extra duty. Colonels Smith, Kimball and Little selected a site for a fort.¹⁵

The smaller settlements were to abandon their locations and move to a larger fort. Paragonah and Johnston's Fort were advised to move into Parowan. New Harmony was advised to come to Cedar Fort. Another entry from the journal kept by the command follows:

August 5, 1853: Colonel Kimball, Dr. Andrews and six of our detachment, in company with 28 teams, went to Harmony to move the plank houses and other effects to Cedar City. Left three men to assist Colonel Little in gathering the cattle in readiness for driving them to Salt Lake City.

August 7, 1853: commenced starting the cattle and driving out the young stock, explaining orders, etc. to the citizens. They threatened to shoot when, by order of Colonel Little, we left the corral.

George A. Bowering's journal contained the following about what took place in Cedar City following this incident:

The Company Commander, Colonel James A. Little, and Bishop P. K. Smith and others separated the cattle. Some opposed it and brought out their guns threatening to shoot anyone who touched their cattle which caused the business to be halted.

August 9: The following men were put under guard for their rebellion yesterday: Joseph Hunter, George Hunter, John Gregory, William Adshead, David Stoddard, and Richard Varley who later was acquitted. Court martial found the five guilty.

A notice was given that the fort [the original fort, west of the 'Knoll'] be vacated on Wednesday, next, and that the inhabitants move over to the south side of the Creek upon the plot [Plat A] appointed for a city, and there build a [walled] fort one-half mile square. Sensible as the defense and conciliation strategy was, full compliance required enormous personal sacrifice.

Some communities complied, some did not. Since Cedar City was so far away from the open fighting it seemed somewhat extreme to send their cattle to Salt Lake City, especially since acquiring livestock had taken a great effort and the settlers weren't even sure when and if the animals would be returned.

August 11: General pulling down and moving of all useable material and goods into the new fort. Soon every house was down.

August 15, Sunday: This morning Elders George A. Smith and Franklin D. Richards held a council with the authorities. At 3 o'clock p.m. a meeting was held outdoors near the house of Elder James A. Little. President Lunt and others addressed the congregation on 'redeeming ourselves from all disgrace that is upon us respecting the cattle.' The motion that we send more cattle away carried. The motion that Bishop P. K. Smith and Elder John D. Lee be the judges to say what cattle go away and what remain carried. It was also motioned that a petition be sent to Parowan to redeem our brethren who are prisoners.¹⁶

In the report of Aug. 15, William H. Kimball wrote:

Colonel Kimball arrived from Parowan that day and received from Cedar City 49 head of cattle--in the evening received 109 head from Bishop Lewis of Parowan. Placed the prisoners in charge of Major John D. Lee. The next day received 88 head of cattle from Coal Creek and 25 more head from Parowan. Left Red Creek [Paragonah] for Great Salt Lake City at 9 o'clock a.m. with 271 head of cattle, and 4 head of horses. Arrived at Beaver at 3 o'clock a.m. of Wednesday, the 17th. August 21: Let the Indians have a steer which was too fat to travel. Pauvan Chief and five others were with us.

Henry Lunt Biography

The company arrived with the cattle at the foot of Utah Mountain (Jordan) on August 24.¹⁷ This stock was delivered to the Church Tithing Office where Bishop Hunter refused to receive them. They were turned across the Jordan River, and the people in Cedar City heard no more about their cattle.¹⁸

The southern settlements had complied with the delivery of their surplus cattle, but even with a court of inquiry regarding the six men that openly opposed this, the issue did not go away. According to the records written on August 25, 1853, from the headquarters of the Nauvoo Legion in Salt Lake City, even though the court of inquiry found the men guilty of the charges, the Governor counseled the militia to "pursue this no further in consideration of the offenders and the strong interest by the people in their behalf." His advice was to discharge them and retain their guns as public property.¹⁹

California beckoned to some of the settlers who didn't agree with sending their cattle to Salt Lake and were not as dedicated, perhaps, to the building up of Zion in this desolate region. One settler, George K. Bowering, outlined two interesting entries in his journal:

October 8, 1853: As several of the brethren are dissatisfied with things, and the Government of Affairs in the presiding officers being tyrannical in their rule, they are preparing to go to California. They cannot stand it, and are preparing to arm themselves with weapons of defense. If they were followed by the officers to try and bring them back, they would try the virtue of bows and arrows, that they would not be brought back alive.

October 16: Some of our California brethren started out today.

In a history written by John Urie of Cedar City, he wrote: "A resolution was quickly formed and put into practice to move from the point [north of Cedar City] onto the new City Plot, which was fully accomplished in double quick time. So far as we were concerned nothing came of it beyond continual guarding and consolidation of

interest in occupying the new Town Plot. Later in the season a large influx of immigrants from the north came in. We were now nearly 1,000 strong--men, women, and children"²⁰

There were only twelve white casualties of the Walker War. None of these were in military action. Most could have been avoided had the advice of the leaders been followed. For example, two teamsters were killed August 17 near Salt Lake City when they injudiciously were bringing lumber from a mill in Parley's Park. Similar indiscretion on the part of some men who ventured to haul wheat from Manti to Salt Lake City climaxed in their massacre at Uintah Springs, October 1st. Thanks to the many protecting walls and vigilant guards, not a woman or child was killed. This, for the time, is an extraordinary record in the conservation of life.

While the human loss was kept down to the minimum, the loss of stock was considerable, amounting to approximately 400 head. While most of the communities slept peacefully behind walls, others who were pressed for time minimized the danger and neglected, or only partially met, the instructions given them. The most noted case was that of Allred's settlement in Sanpete County which lost 200 head of cattle. The settlers here were living far apart and had not built a fort. Brigham Young warned them of the danger of not living in closer quarters and building a corral and fort for their protection.²¹

As a conclusion to what was known as the "Walker War," Governor Young and a retinue of high church and territorial officials met the haughty Ute Leader, Chief Walker, and Chief Kanosh on Chicken Creek (Levan) with loads of presents. In the spring of 1854, after the leading men on both sides completed the traditional ceremony of smoking the peace pipe, they reached an agreement which ended the hostilities of the War. Chief Walker died the next winter in January 1855. The Indians killed one of his wives, an Indian prisoner, and 50 of their finest horses to bury with him. They put all his firearms and insignia or rank in his grave so that he might enter the happy hunting ground as a great chief should.²²

Henry Lunt Biography

1. William E. Berrett, *The Restored Church*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book Company, 1969) p. 252.
2. Milton R. Hunter, *The Founding of Utah*, (1922), p. 270.
3. Matthias F. Cowley, *Wilford Woodruff*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Bookcraft, 1964).
4. Andrew Jenson, *L.D.S. Journal History*, Entry for February 12, 1853
5. *Ibid.*, Published in the *Deseret News* on July 4, 1853.
6. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," Entry of July 2, 1853, (Provo, Utah: B. Y.U Library, copied 1955 from original manuscript), p. 208.
7. Andrew Neff, *History of Utah 1847 - 1869*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: The Deseret News Press, 1940), p. 370.
8. *Ibid.*, p. 372.
9. *Ibid.*, p. 374.
10. *Ibid.*, p. 374.
11. Milton R. Hunter, *Founding of Utah*, (1922), Walker War, p. 274.
12. George K. Bowering, "George K. Bowering Journal," 1853 Entry, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
13. Utah Historical Society, "Walker War," *Utah Historical Quarterly*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Published 1991.
14. *Ibid.*
15. Andrew Jenson, "Exploration Company of Lt. Col. Kimball," August 5, 1853," *L.D.S. Journal History*, p. 9.
16. George K. Bowering, *op. cit.*, August, 1853, p. 165.
17. Andrew Jenson, *op. cit.*, p. 11.
18. Rhoda Wood, "Rhoda Wood History," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
19. Lt. General D. H. Wells, "Military Report," from the Headquarters of the Nauvoo Legion, August 25, 1853, (From History File of Morris Shirts, Cedar City, Ut.).
20. John Urie, "History of Cedar City," (Source: L.D.S. Film Crmh 1514).
21. Andrew Neff, *op. cit.*, p. 376.
22. Luella A. Dalton, *History of Iron County Mission*, (Published by Author, 1960) p. 90.



GEORGE A. SMITH

He was appointed as head of the Iron Mission, Iron County, in 1850



JOHN D. LEE

The people involved in the Iron Mission left Salt Lake City Dec. 7, 1850, and Lee was appointed as Clerk. Henry Lunt was President Smith's private secretary. This was probably because Lee and Lunt were both literate.